

Ecclesiastical Latin

EL-I.3: First and Second Declension Nouns

Produce and parse first- and second-declension nouns, including neuters and vocatives, in connected phrases

Stage	Stage I — Foundations
Prerequisite	EL-I.2 mastery: justify case, number, gender, agreement, and government
Next	EL-I.4, The Third Declension

Read *EL-GUIDE: Start Here* before using this packet. Course method, pacing, source conventions, and answer protocol are stated there; this module begins with its lesson and assumes previously taught terms.

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Part I

Lesson

CHAPTER 1

Unit 3: First and Second Declension Nouns

On completing this unit, you can:

- decline a regular first-declension noun and masculine and neuter second-declension nouns;
- apply the neuter nominative–accusative rule and form vocatives;
- identify case from ending plus syntax when endings overlap; and
- read first- and second-declension forms in Mass and biblical phrases.

1.1 Exact paradigms

The **declension** is the noun’s pattern of case endings. First-declension genitive singular ends in *-æ*; second-declension genitive singular in *-i*. A **paradigm** is an ordered display of every form in such a pattern; each cell represents a particular case and number. Learn forms vertically and horizontally.

	<i>missa, -æ f.</i>		<i>dominus, -i m.</i>		<i>verbum, -i n.</i>	
	sg.	pl.	sg.	pl.	sg.	pl.
Nom.	missa	missæ	dominus	domini	verbum	verba
Gen.	missæ	missarum	domini	dominorum	verbi	verborum
Dat.	missæ	missis	domino	dominis	verbo	verbis
Acc.	missam	missas	dominum	dominos	verbum	verba
Abl.	missa	missis	domino	dominis	verbo	verbis
Voc.	missa	missæ	domine	domini	verbum	verba

In every neuter noun, nominative and accusative are identical; their plural ends in *-a*. A regular masculine noun in *-us* has vocative singular *-e*: *dominus* → *Domine*. Nouns in *-ius* normally have vocative *-i*, as *filius* → *fili*. *Deus* has liturgical and classical irregularities; learn its attested forms in phrases rather than forcing every slot into the regular *dominus* pattern.

Biblical and liturgical Latin regularly uses masculine plural *cæli*, *cælorum* alongside neuter singular *cælum*, *cæli*, rather than the regular neuter plural *cæla*. This explains masculine plural *pleni* in *pleni sunt cæli et terra*; record the singular and liturgical plural behavior together in the lexicon.

Worked example: *In principio creavit Deus cælum et terram* (Gn 1:1)

Worked passage ID: *W.I.8*; exact source and collation state are recorded in the passage inventory.

in with ablative *principio* means “in the beginning”. *creavit* is the finite verb, “created”. *Deus* is nominative singular subject. *cælum* is accusative singular neuter and *terram* accusative singular feminine; they are coordinated direct objects. Translation: “In the beginning God created heaven and earth.” The ending and syntax distinguish accusative *cælum* from the identical nominative form.

Worked example: *Per omnia sæcula sæculorum*

Worked passage ID: W.I.9; exact source and collation state are recorded in the passage inventory.

per governs accusative. *omnia* is accusative plural neuter and agrees with *sæcula*, accusative plural neuter. *sæculorum* is genitive plural, “of ages”. Literal translation: “through all ages of ages”; idiomatically, “for ever and ever”.

Worked example: *Deo gratias*

Worked passage ID: W.I.10; exact source and collation state are recorded in the passage inventory.

The second-declension ending *-o* could be dative or ablative singular. Here the implied act of giving thanks needs a recipient, so *Deo* is dative, not ablative. *gratias* is first-declension accusative plural. Translation: “Thanks be to God.”

Worked example: *Peccata mundi*

Worked passage ID: W.I.11; exact source and collation state are recorded in the passage inventory.

peccata is nominative or accusative plural neuter of *peccatum*; the clause decides which. *mundi* is genitive singular of *mundus*, “of the world”. In *qui tollis peccata mundi*, the verb *tollis* makes *peccata* its accusative object: “the sins of the world”.

1.2 Handwritten study and controlled composition

Write each paradigm once while looking, once from memory, and once in the order accusative–nominative–genitive–dative–ablative–vocative. Circle every ending shared by more than one case. Parse all nouns in Genesis 1:1 above. Then compose *Dominus amat Ecclesiam*, “the Lord loves the Church”; change subject and object to plural, *Domini amant Ecclesias*; and make direct address plus command, *Domine, ama Ecclesiam*. The last verb is supplied as a model; the noun changes remain the assessed work.

Part II

Practice

CHAPTER 1

Transfer, retrieval, and application

1.1 Exact paradigms — transfer practice

Connection. A small high-frequency mini-lexicon links complete dictionary entries to the forms actually encountered in the Missal.

Transfer task. Build a six-entry card from lesson nouns: two first-declension, two masculine second-declension, and two neuter second-declension entries. For each, write nominative, genitive, gender, stem, and one liturgically frequent oblique form already used in the lesson.

Retrieval check. Cover the card and state the neuter rule and the information supplied by a noun's genitive singular.

1.2 Handwritten study and controlled composition — transfer practice

Connection. Changing number or clause role tests a whole paradigm more effectively than reciting endings in a fixed order.

Transfer task. Apply the lesson's singular-to-plural and statement-to-address transformations. Underline the stem once and box the ending in every changed noun.

Retrieval check. Explain why a vocative transformation changes *Dominus* but does not turn an object into a vocative.

Part III

Worksheets

CHAPTER 1

Unit 3: First and Second Declensions

Worksheet I.9 — Variant A

Worksheet ID: I.9

Focus: Paradigms, neuters, vocatives, and liturgical noun phrases**Use:** Write full forms, not ending fragments.

1. Give these forms of *missa*, *missæ* f.: genitive singular, dative plural, accusative plural, ablative singular.

-
2. Give these forms of *dominus*, *domini* m.: vocative singular, accusative singular, nominative plural, genitive plural.

-
3. Apply the neuter rule to *verbum*, *verbi* n.: give nominative/accusative singular and nominative/accusative plural.

-
4. Transform *Dominus servum vocat* so that plural lords call plural servants; label both noun cases.

-
5. Translate and parse the noun phrase *per omnia sæcula sæculorum*.

-
6. **Text:** *In principio creavit Deus cælum et terram.*

Passage ID: I.9.1; exact source and collation state are recorded in the passage inventory.

Parse each noun and translate.

Worksheet I.12 — Variant D**Worksheet ID:** I.12**Focus:** Paradigm recall, neuter control, and syntax**Use:** This may replace any other Unit 3 variant.

1. Write the full plural paradigm of *missa*, *missæ* *f.* in case order.

2. Write the full singular paradigm of *verbum*, *verbi* *n.* in case order.

3. Give the requested form: “of God”; “O Lord”; “to the son”; “with gifts”; “the churches” as direct object.

4. Explain why *dona* in *dona nobis pacem* and *dona Dei* should not receive the same analysis.

5. Correct *Filius custodit ecclesia Domini*, intended “The Son guards the Church of the Lord”.

6. **Text:** *Peccata mundi tollis*.

Passage ID: I.12.1; exact source and collation state are recorded in the passage inventory.

This is a controlled transformation of *qui tollis peccata mundi*, not a received quotation; apply the neuter rule and parse the genitive.

Part IV

Assessment

CHAPTER 1

Mastery assessment and record

Advance when: Write at least 34 of the 36 displayed forms correctly, justify at least eight of ten ambiguous first- or second-declension forms by syntax, and read an unseen two-clause sample without treating a neuter plural as singular.

Complete the assessment before opening the answer part. Record evidence, not confidence or elapsed time.

Evidence	First attempt	Delayed check
Date and conditions		
Worksheet ID and score		
Mastery task and result		
One recurring error family		
Correction stated as a rule		
Unseen or remediation item used		

If the criterion is met: continue to EL-I.4, The Third Declension.

If it is not met: Worksheets I.10 and I.11 remain optional remediation or delayed-recall variants.

Advance / remediate decision: _____ **Next review date:** _____

Reason in one complete sentence: _____

Part V

Answer Key

Open this part only after completing the assessment record. Use the comparison and alternative-answer protocol in EL-GUIDE.

CHAPTER 1

Practice models and rubrics

Exact paradigms — model and rubric

Model / acceptable evidence. A correct card preserves each lesson dictionary entry, derives the stem from the genitive, and labels the selected oblique form accurately. The retrieval statement must say that neuter nominative and accusative are identical and that neuter plurals end in *-a*; the genitive identifies the stem and declensional pattern.

Handwritten study and controlled composition — model and rubric

Model / acceptable evidence. The transformed forms must preserve their intended clause roles and use the correct number. A sound explanation distinguishes morphological vocative marking from syntactic role: only the person addressed becomes vocative; an object remains accusative even when another noun changes to direct address.

CHAPTER 2

Unit 3: First and Second Declensions

Solution I.9 — Variant A

Worksheet ID: I.9

Focus: Paradigms, neuters, vocatives, and liturgical noun phrases

Use: Write full forms, not ending fragments.

1. Give these forms of *missa*, *missæ* f.: genitive singular, dative plural, accusative plural, ablative singular.
Answer / model: *missæ, missis, missas, missa*.
2. Give these forms of *dominus*, *domini* m.: vocative singular, accusative singular, nominative plural, genitive plural.
Answer / model: *domine, dominum, domini, dominorum*.
3. Apply the neuter rule to *verbum*, *verbi* n.: give nominative/accusative singular and nominative/accusative plural.
Answer / model: Singular nominative and accusative: *verbum*; plural nominative and accusative: *verba*.
4. Transform *Dominus servum vocat* so that plural lords call plural servants; label both noun cases.
Answer / model: *Domini servos vocant*. *Domini* is nominative plural; *servos* is accusative plural.
5. Translate and parse the noun phrase *per omnia sæcula sæculorum*.
Answer / model: “through all ages of ages” or idiomatically “forever and ever”. *per* governs neuter plural accusative *omnia sæcula*; *sæculorum* is neuter plural genitive.
6. **Text:** *In principio creavit Deus cælum et terram*.
Passage ID: I.9.1; exact source and collation state are recorded in the passage inventory.
Parse each noun and translate.
Answer / notes: *principio*: neuter singular ablative after *in*; *Deus*: masculine singular nominative subject; *cælum*: neuter singular accusative object; *terram*: feminine singular accusative coordinated object. “In the beginning God created heaven and earth.”

Solution I.12 — Variant D

Worksheet ID: I.12

Focus: Paradigm recall, neuter control, and syntax

Use: This may replace any other Unit 3 variant.

1. Write the full plural paradigm of *missa*, *missæ* f. in case order.

Answer / model: *missæ, missarum, missis, missas, missis, missæ.*

2. Write the full singular paradigm of *verbum*, *verbi* n. in case order.

Answer / model: *verbum, verbi, verbo, verbum, verbo, verbum.*

3. Give the requested form: “of God”; “O Lord”; “to the son”; “with gifts”; “the churches” as direct object.

Answer / model: *Dei; Domine; filio; cum donis; ecclesias.*

4. Explain why *dona* in *dona nobis pacem* and *dona Dei* should not receive the same analysis.

Answer / model: In *dona nobis*, *dona* is the singular imperative “grant”. In *dona Dei*, it is neuter plural nominative or accusative noun “gifts”, modified by genitive *Dei*. Syntax and dictionary possibilities decide.

5. Correct *Filius custodit ecclesia Domini*, intended “The Son guards the Church of the Lord”.

Answer / model: *Filius custodit Ecclesiam Domini*. Direct object *Ecclesiam* must be accusative; *Domini* is correctly genitive.

6. **Text:** *Peccata mundi tollis*.

Passage ID: I.12.1; exact source and collation state are recorded in the passage inventory.

This is a controlled transformation of *qui tollis peccata mundi*, not a received quotation; apply the neuter rule and parse the genitive.

Answer / notes: *peccata*: neuter plural accusative object; neuter plural nominative would look identical, but second-person verb and context make it object. *mundi*: masculine singular genitive. Understood subject: *tu*. “You take away the sins of the world.”

Part VI

Scope and Sources

CHAPTER 1

Scope and Qualifications

1.1 Packet boundary

This is module EL-I.3, *First and Second Declension Nouns*, in Triptych's print-first Ecclesiastical Latin curriculum. It imports one authoritative lesson, transfer practice for its internal submodules, two selected worksheets, one local mastery assessment, and matching solutions. This packet covers the first two noun declensions and their frequent liturgical uses, not the complete noun system.

The unprinted worksheet variants remain course-owned extension material; their omission is intentional and is not a claim that the module exhausts available practice. EL-GUIDE owns the course-wide study method, pacing, lookup discipline, answer protocol, source classes, and advancement rules; this packet assumes that orientation and terminology taught in prerequisite modules.

1.2 Controlling records and local state

Course-wide research records own the edition, passage, answer, curriculum, and source decisions; the leaf's module map records this packet's selection and transfer practice. EL-GUIDE owns the corpus, normalization, translation, non-authority, review, and answer conventions that apply here. Claim-local qualifications remain beside the affected material; check received wording against the course-wide passage inventory.

Any installed snapshot is a working study held from release until its exact bytes and outstanding distribution gates receive separate authorization.

CHAPTER 2

References

The following works are the course's controlling corpus and reference aids. Project-composed explanation, translation, analysis, exercises, and models are distinguished from received wording under the convention stated in the Scope and Qualifications appendix. Short source passages are identified so that the learner can verify their wider context. The adjacent edition manifest and passage inventory record exact source roles, checks, access states, and known rights limits.

2.1 Primary corpus

- Catholic Church, *Missale Romanum ex decreto SS. Concilii Tridentini restitutum, Summorum Pontificum cura recognitum*, editio typica (Rome, 1962). A searchable presentation of the edition is hosted by the Holy See's Biblia Clerus project: <https://www.clerus.org/bibliaclerusonline/EN/gmb.htm>.
- A page-image scan of the 1962 typical edition is available through the Church Music Association of America: <https://media.churchmusicassociation.org/pdf/missale62.pdf>. Page images, rather than unsourced transcriptions, should decide doubtful punctuation or spelling.

- The Clementine Vulgate is the principal biblical comparison corpus. The public-domain 1914 edition edited by Michael Hetzenauer and its provenance are described at <https://www.sacredbible.org/vulgate1914/>.

2.2 Grammar and lexicography

- J. H. Allen and J. B. Greenough, *New Latin Grammar for Schools and Colleges* (1903), a donor-declared public-domain reference whose digital locator was not independently consulted during integration: <https://archive.org/details/allengreenoughsn01alle>.
- Charles E. Bennett, *New Latin Grammar*, 1918 revision, Project Gutenberg eBook 15665; public-domain text in the United States: <https://www.gutenberg.org/ebooks/15665>.
- Charlton T. Lewis and Charles Short, *A Latin Dictionary* (1879), searchable transcription: <https://logeion.uchicago.edu/lexidium>.
- Charles du Fresne, sieur du Cange, *Glossarium mediae et infimae latinitatis*, a donor-declared later-vocabulary aid whose digital locator was not independently consulted during integration: <http://ducange.enc.sorbonne.fr/>.

The underlying 1903, 1918, 1879, and 1883–1887 printed works are public domain in the United States. Digital transcriptions and interfaces retain their own terms and are cited as access tools, not relicensed or reproduced wholesale. The 1962 Missal, Scripture, official text, and other received wording retain their own status; see the scope appendix, research records, and final-page rights notice.

Classical reference grammars describe the inherited system but do not by themselves explain every biblical or ecclesiastical development. The advanced volume therefore distinguishes classical baseline, Vulgate usage, later Christian usage, and stable liturgical formula instead of labeling every difference an “exception.”

2.3 Citation convention

Missal passages are cited by liturgical location and text genre rather than by a page number that varies among printings. Biblical texts are cited by book, chapter, and verse. Historical authors are cited by work and section wherever possible. A learner preparing a formal commentary should verify each passage against the edition actually being used and record any variant. These references are not a claim that every historical-linguistic question can be settled by the listed school grammars and dictionary interfaces.

CHAPTER 3

Generation Metadata

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Model: GPT-5-based Codex agent; unexposed: exact model identifier and model qualifiers

Agent/runtime: OpenAI Codex agents (curriculum architecture, module design, enrichment, source and answer audit, correction, production, and review); Codex CLI 0.144.6; API workspace; unexposed: server revision

Agent/runtime: OpenAI Codex agents (whole-curriculum structure audit, shared typesetting and selection correction, rendered-structure regression checks, production, and review); Codex CLI 0.144.6; API workspace; unexposed: server revision

Agent/runtime: OpenAI Codex agents (whole-curriculum Part-scoped numbering and rendered contents hierarchy correction, rendered contents-geometry regression checking, production, and review); Codex CLI 0.144.6; API workspace; unexposed: server revision

Agent/runtime: OpenAI Codex agents (starter-guide consolidation, module-flow and definition-retrieval revision, stage-boundary assessment correction, catalog and audit records, production, and review); Codex CLI 0.144.6; API workspace; unexposed: server revision

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